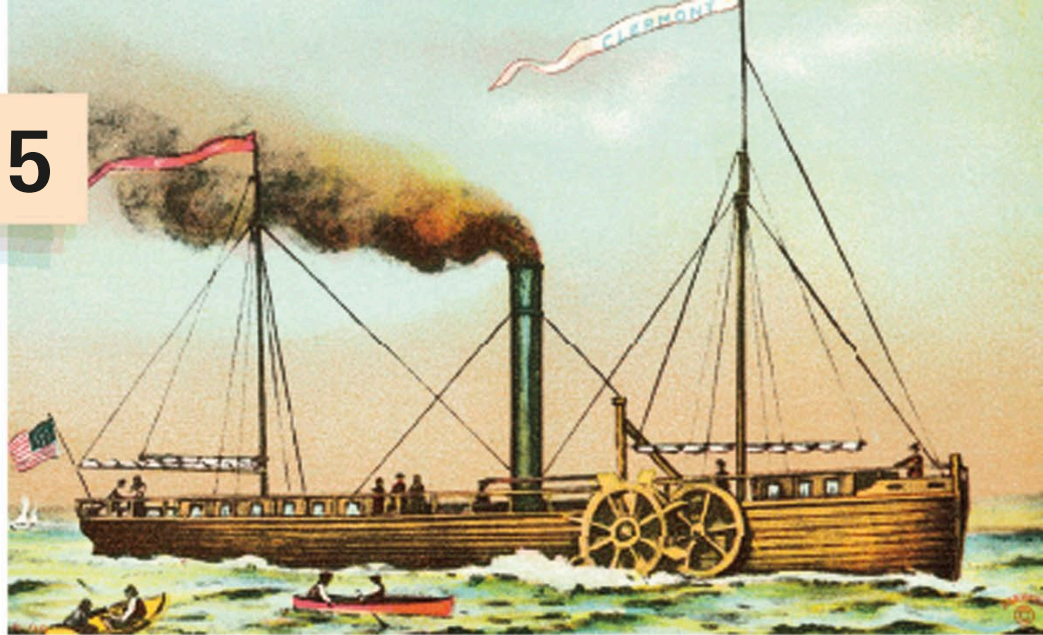


1805 ▶ 1815

1807

River steamboat

American engineer Robert Fulton built a steamboat, the *Clermont*, to carry passengers from New York City to Albany, NY, along the Hudson River. The boat had two paddle wheels and completed the 150 mile (240 km) trip in just over 30 hours.



The *Clermont* steamboat



Meriwether Lewis and William Clark arrived on the Pacific Coast of the US in 1806. On their journey across North America, they discovered new plants and animals.

1810

First tin can

Peter Durand, a British merchant, patented a method for preserving meat by sealing it in an iron container coated with tin to prevent rusting. By 1818, the British Royal Navy was consuming 24,000 large cans of meat a year. Today, food cans are made of 100 percent steel, though in other ways the process has changed very little.



1805

1810

1809

First electric light

British chemist Humphry Davy connected two sticks of charcoal to a large battery. The continuous flow of electricity between them created an incredibly bright light. Davy's arc lamp, as it was called, was the world's first electric light. Davy made other contributions to science, including the discovery of the elements chlorine and iodine.

1809

How the giraffe got its neck

French biologist Jean-Baptiste Lamarck came up with one of the first theories about the evolution of life. He believed that species change over time by passing on characteristics acquired during their lifetime. For example, giraffes gained their long necks because generations of giraffes reached up to feed from higher and higher branches on trees.



Platform for driver

Understanding evolution
See pages 120–121